Phase 9 | Final Interview Cheat Sheet

Review the short version: pitch, architecture, stack, claims and code landmarks.

React/Vite Edition | Repository-grounded study material | Snapshot: 2026-10-24

1. 30-second pitch

Ready Scout is a disaster-preparedness learning platform built with React/Vite, Node.js/Express and MongoDB Atlas. It combines learning content, an earthquake drill, alert views and a nearby-services map. A separate Flask service connects the chatbot to Gemini. It is an educational prototype, and its external data providers require configuration and operational verification.

2. Architecture in one line

React/Vite + React Router -> Express REST API -> MongoDB Atlas; separate Flask -> Gemini; alert and POI providers -> normalized data; Leaflet renders maps; Phaser runs the earthquake simulation.

3. Stack quick reference

Concern	Technology
Frontend	React, Vite, React Router, Tailwind CSS
Runtime/API	Node.js, Express.js
Database	MongoDB Atlas, Mongoose
Authentication	JWT, bcryptjs, Passport.js, Google OAuth 2.0
Chatbot	Flask, Python requests, Gemini API
Map/game	Leaflet.js, OpenStreetMap tiles, Geoapify Places, Phaser 3
Hosting	Vercel frontend, Render backend; configuration also supports Express static hosting

4. Important distinctions

- React is the UI library; Vite is the build/dev tool; React Router is client-side navigation.
- Node.js is the runtime; Express is the web framework.
- MongoDB Atlas is the managed database; Mongoose is the ODM.
- Leaflet renders maps; Geoapify searches POIs; OpenStreetMap provides underlying data/tiles.
- Passport performs Google OAuth; the app issues a separate JWT.
- CAP is the alert format parsed into readable fields.

5. Claims to avoid

- Do not call Ready Scout a verified emergency response platform.
- Do not claim the locator is operational unless the deployed key and request are verified.
- Do not claim every nearby facility is present; place data may be incomplete.
- Do not present fire/flood pages as fully interactive modules if they remain scaffolds.
- Do not claim all USGS/GDACS utilities are active in the ticker without checking the rendered data path.

6. Environment names and local ports

Backend: MONGO_URI, JWT_SECRET, SESSION_SECRET, FRONTEND_URL, GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID, GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET, GEOAPIFY_API_KEY. Frontend: VITE_FLASK_URL and feed URL settings. Flask: GEMINI_API_KEY. Local ports: Vite 5173, Express 5000, Flask 5001. Store values only in ignored local env files or deployment secret settings.

7. Source landmarks

React routes: frontend/src/App.jsx. Express setup: backend/index.js. User schema: backend/models/User.js. Auth middleware: backend/middleware/authMiddleware.js. Auth routes: backend/routes/authRoutes.js. Alerts: backend/routes/alertRoutes.js and frontend/src/lib. Nearby: backend/routes/nearbyRoutes.js and frontend/src/app/dashboard/student/nearby/page.jsx. Chat: flask/app.py and frontend/src/app/dashboard/chatbot/page.jsx. Phaser game: frontend/public/earthquake_drill/game.js.